Product Release Vision and Scope

ADHD Budgeting App · AI Development Residency, Fall 2026

Words to know: MVP = our first test version, shared with about 100 invited testers (a "closed beta"). **MMP** = the first finished version, in the app stores for everyone. **Epic** = a big group of related features. **Sprint** = a 2-week block of work.

1. Business Requirements and Context

1.1 Why build this?

- About 1 in 14 adults has ADHD.
- Most budgeting apps need daily effort and close attention, so people with ADHD often quit within weeks.
- Money apps are not designed for ADHD, and ADHD apps don't handle money. No app does both.
- Apps for ADHD are a growing market: from $2.22 billion in 2025 to $4.71 billion by 2030.

1.2 Objectives

- Show that an app designed for ADHD helps people keep budgeting, and come back after a break.
- Start testing with about 100 people with ADHD in week 15.
- Use what testers tell us to shape the public launch.

1.3 Risks (from the build plan's risk review)

- People may not trust a new app with their bank.
- We may not find enough testers with ADHD. Our goal is 150 sign-ups, about half of them women.
- There may be too much to build in time, and the safety work is new to us.
- People may stop typing in their spending. We count how many days a week each tester logs; if it drops, we add bank linking sooner.
- Each big risk has a fix, an owner and a due date in the build plan.

1.4 Stakeholders (who is involved)

- **Team:** product manager, designer, and developers working with Claude Code (an AI coding helper).
- **Reviewers:** the instructor and stakeholders, who see a demo every 2 weeks.
- **Users:** beta testers with ADHD.
- **Partners:** Plaid (connects to banks), Supabase (stores backups online), Apple and Google (app stores).

2. Product Vision

2.1 Vision statement

> **Help adults with ADHD see what they can safely spend in one glance, and come back to their budget after any break without guilt.**

2.2 Goals

- See what is safe to spend right away.
- Log spending in seconds.
- Come back after a break without guilt.
- Fewer surprise bills and late fees.

2.3 Value proposition (why people will choose us)

For adults with ADHD who keep giving up on budgets, our app combines real money tools with calm, ADHD-friendly design. Staying on top of money takes minutes, not willpower.

2.4 Main features

- **Safe-to-spend number:** how much you can spend today, after bills
- **Money buckets:** Spending, Bills and Savings
- **Quick add:** log spending in 2 taps, with undo
- **Bill countdown:** bills due this week, with reminders you can snooze
- **Fresh start:** one tap to restart after a break
- **Quick setup:** 5 minutes or less, and it saves your place
- **Fun money:** a small planned amount for spending on a whim, guilt-free
- **Pause before buying** and **Focus Mode** (both optional)

2.5 Assumptions and dependencies

- **We assume** people will start by typing in their balance, without linking a bank on day one.
- **We depend on** Plaid for bank connections (practice banks during the beta), Supabase for backups, app store approval, and a safety review before any real data is stored.

Decisions still open (from the build plan, with the week they are due): beta start date (week 1), who the beta is for (week 6), auto-lock time (week 7), and the app's name (week 12).

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3. Release Scope

3.1 This release: MVP closed beta

- **Who:** about 100 adults with ADHD who have given up on budgets, or keep getting surprised by bills.
- **When:** testing runs from week 15 to week 26.
- **Built first (the top 5):** safe-to-spend number, quick add, bill countdown, fresh start, and quick setup.
- **If we run late, we drop (in this order):** pause before buying, home-screen widget, bill finder, bank linking.
- **What:** Epic 1 Easy Start, Epic 2 Money at a Glance and Epic 3 Calm Habits. Underneath, built first: strong safety (locked data, face unlock, a 5-minute auto-lock, and money hidden when you switch apps).

3.2 Next release: MMP public launch

- **Who:** the same people, plus couples where one partner has ADHD.
- **What:** Epic 4 Shared Support: couples mode, sharing with an ADHD coach, savings goals with a progress picture, group check-ins, and alerts for new subscriptions.
- Everything from the beta, improved using tester feedback.

3.3 Limitations (what it won't do)

- No investing, credit scores, detailed reports, streaks or points.
- No financial advice. It gives budgeting tools only.
- In the beta, only practice banks link; real spending is typed in.
- Phone app only (iPhone and Android).

4. Work Breakdown and Roadmap

4.1 Epics, features and tasks

The work is split into 4 epics, each with 5 features, and each feature is split into small tasks. For example: **Epic 2 Money at a Glance** → feature **Safe-to-spend number** → tasks: work out the money math and test it, design the home screen, and build a screen that shows how the number was worked out.

Features are ranked by how much they help compared with how long they take, and sorted into Must have, Should have, Could have and Won't have (for now). Must-haves are built first.

4.2 Themes (the big ideas behind the work)

Easy start · Money at a glance · Calm, guilt-free habits · Safe and private · Shared support (later)

4.3 Roadmap (our best guess, updated every 2 weeks)

We follow 7 Agile steps: research, feature list, sprint plan, effort guess, build and test, release, improve. Steps 3 to 5 repeat in every sprint.

Research Weeks 1–2

Build in 6 sprints Weeks 3–14: safety first, then money basics, setup, habits and bank linking

Closed beta Weeks 15–26: about 100 testers; we fix their biggest problems every 2 weeks

Public launch After the beta

5. Success Metrics and KPIs

KPIs (key performance indicators) are the numbers that tell us if it worked.

What we measure	Goal
Testers still using it after 4 weeks	**4 in 10**
Testers who come back after a week away	**6 in 10**
Time to finish setup	**5 minutes or less**
Late fees or overdrafts by month 3	**30% fewer**
Serious safety problems at launch	**None**
Public launch: active users, app rating, paying users	Set after the beta

6. Governance and Maintenance

- The **product manager** owns the plan and the list of features, sorted into Must have, Should have, Could have and Won't have (for now).
- **Every 2 weeks:** we show the new work to 3 to 5 people with ADHD, talk about what to improve, and update the plan.
- The **instructor and stakeholders** approve any change to what we build or when.
- **Quality checks:** someone reviews every code change, automatic tests run on every change, and a safety review happens before each release.
- **A sprint is done only when** it works on a real phone, its tests pass, every screen is calm and has all four states (empty, loading, success, error), and the safety and accessibility checks pass.
- **After the beta:** we delete testers' data, or ask before keeping it. By week 13 we decide who will run the app and pay for it.

Sources: ADHD Budgeting App PRD; project FigJam board; MVP Build Plan and one-page Agile plan; market data from The Business Research Company.

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